THE GIRL IN THE TREES

Written by

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Approx. Runtime: 7 Minutes

EXT. PARK - NIGHT

A quiet neighborhood park sits nearly empty under dim streetlights. Old swings creak in the wind. The basketball court fence rattles softly. Music plays from a phone speaker. Five teenagers sit around a picnic table covered in junk food wrappers, soda bottles, cigarettes, and backpacks.

JAX, 17, acts like the leader.

MIA, 16, sarcastic and bored, films random clips on her phone.

LEXI, 17, laughs while drawing on the picnic table with a marker.

NOAH, 16, always smoking, awkward, trying to fit in. Loud and reckless, tosses empty cans across the park.

TYLER
Bet you twenty bucks I can hit the trash can from here.

He throws the bottle. Misses badly. Everyone laughs.

MIA
You suck.

JAX
Dude, you suck at everything except getting suspended.

Tyler flips him off jokingly. Noah looks toward the woods behind the park. Dark. Still.

NOAH
You guys ever think this place is creepy at night?

Suddenly, A branch SNAPS loudly from the woods. Everyone goes quiet.

LEXI
Ok.. that was weird

Tyler shines his flashlight toward the trees. Nothing.

TYLER
Probably an amimal

Another SNAP. Closer. Then, A LITTLE GIRL slowly steps out of the woods.

She’s around eight years old. Barefoot. Oversized hoodie. Messy, tangled hair covered half her face. Mud and dark stains cover her clothes. Blood dripping from her forehead, blood all over her chlothes

She says nothing.The teens stare at her.

MIA
Uh...

JAX
Yo, kid, are you okay?

No response. The girl just stares at them. Silent. Unblinking.

TYLER
Why is she just standing there like that?

Lexi lowers her phone.

LEXI
This is actually freaking me out.

Noah slowly steps closer.

NOAH
Hey... are you hurt?

The little girl suddenly looks toward the woods behind her. Terrified. Then back at Noah. Still silent.

JAX
Where are your parents?

Tyler laughs nervously.

TYLER
Okay, this feels like a prank.

He walks closer to her.

TYLER (CONT'D)
You got a name or what?

The little girl takes one slow step backward. Toward the woods. Like she wants distance from them. A distant metallic SCRAPING sound echoes through the trees. Everyone freezes.

MIA
What was that?

The scraping happens again. Dragging. The little girl’s breathing quickens. She shakes her head slightly.

NOAH
It's scared

TYLER
It's not a it, it's a her

NOAH
That is the thing your worried about right now?

The girl finally whispers:

LITTLE GIRL
It comes out at night.

Silence. The wind picks up hard. The swings begin moving behind them.

CREAK. CREAK.

LEXI
Nope. Nope. I hate this.

Tyler shines the flashlight toward the woods again. For half a second— A tall figure stands between the trees. Still. Watching. Tyler quickly lowers the light.

TYLER
Did you guys see that?

Nobody answers. The park lights flicker. ON. OFF. ON. OFF. Then steady again.

JAX
We’re leaving.

The little girl suddenly grabs Noah’s sleeve tightly.

LITTLE GIRL
Don’t let it see you.

A LOUD BANG comes from the park bathroom nearby. Everyone jumps.

MIA
Oh my god

Another BANG. Tyler forces himself to laugh.

TYLER
Someone’s messing with us.

Jax grabs a broken baseball bat from near the bench.

JAX
Fine. Let’s check.

The group slowly walks toward the bathroom building. The little girl stays behind near the swings. Watching. The bathroom door hangs slightly open. Jax pushes it wider with the bat. The group is looking around, too scared to go into the bathroom. The group walks to the side of the bathroom. Then Mia notices something written across the wall in blood, slowly dripping down, still wet.

“SHE FOLLOWED YOU”

MIA
Guys...

Everyone turns slowly. The little girl now stands much closer. Right outside the bathroom. Completely still. And behind her, A tall shadow stands near the trees. Too dark to see clearly. Its shape looks wrong somehow. Too tall. Too thin. The little girl shakes her head quickly. Warning them. The shadow takes one slow step forward. The park lights suddenly shut off. Darkness. Everyone starts screaming and running. Heavy footsteps. Metal scraping across concrete. Noah falls hard onto the pavement. He looks up just in time to see the little girl standing nearby. Watching silently.

CUT TO:

BLACK.

EXT. NOAH’S HOUSE - EARLY MORNING

Noah sits on his front porch, wrapped in a blanket. His MOM kneels beside him while police lights flash faintly in the background down the street.

MOM
Noah... where are your friends?

Noah stares ahead blankly.

NOAH
She tried to warn us.

MOM
Who?

Noah slowly looks across the street. Near the edge of the sidewalk— The little girl stands completely still. Watching him. Noah’s face drops in fear. The little girl slowly raises one finger to her lips. Quiet.